Daylight_aw

Version 1.0 · Instruction manual

Daylight_aw is a free audio plugin that runs one original Airwindows effect per instance. It contains 531 effects by Chris Johnson (Airwindows), from Airwindows Consolidated. The sound is the original code, unchanged and bit-identical to the original plugins.

Formats	VST3 (Windows, macOS, Linux), AU (macOS). 64-bit, Apple silicon and Intel.
Systems	Windows 10/11 · macOS 10.13 or newer · Linux x64
Licence	Free and open source (GNU AGPL v3). No account, no internet connection.

Daylight_aw is not an official Airwindows release. Designed by big_tyme_designs.

Installation

Windows	Close your DAW. Copy `Daylight_aw.vst3` to `C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3\`. Start the DAW and rescan plugins.
macOS	Quit your DAW. Copy `Daylight_aw.component` to `~/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/Components/` and `Daylight_aw.vst3` to `~/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/VST3/`. If macOS blocks the plugin, run the two `xattr` lines from `INSTALL.txt` in Terminal. Restart the DAW and rescan.
Linux	Copy `Daylight_aw.vst3` to `~/.vst3/` and rescan.
Updating	Close the DAW completely, then replace the plugin file(s). Projects, presets and settings are kept. Effects are never removed or renamed, so older projects always open.
Uninstalling	Delete the plugin file(s). Your presets and settings stay in the folder listed under *Your files*.

Getting started

1. Insert **Daylight_aw** on a track. The effect browser opens.
2. Choose a folder or type in the search field, then click an effect and confirm with **Load effect**.
3. The window now shows that effect's controls. Click the effect name at the top for presets and settings.

An instance keeps its effect for good, so a project can never change sound by accident. For another effect, insert another Daylight_aw.

The window



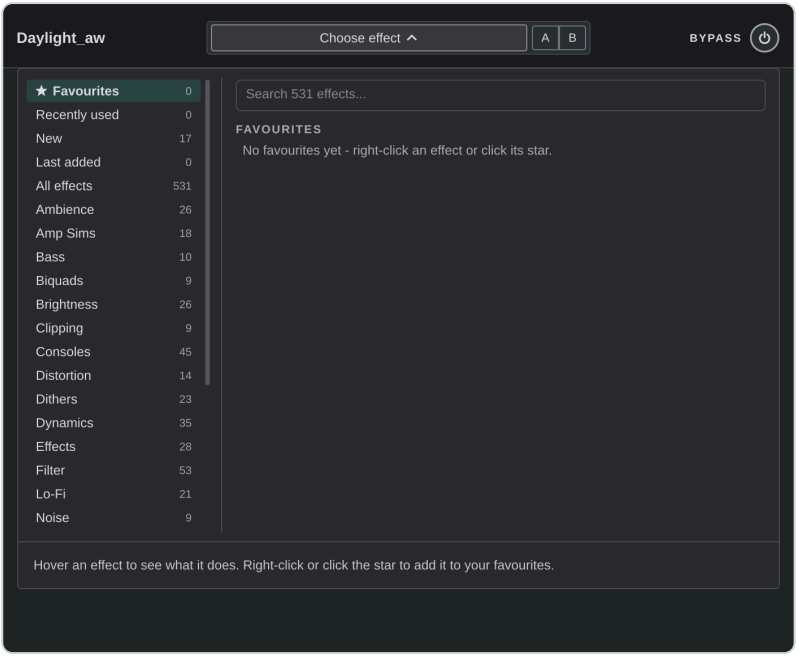
1 Name	Click for version, credits and licences.
2 Effect / preset	Click to open presets and settings. Shows the preset name, with ***** when changed since loading. Trims other than 0 dB are shown here (e.g. *IN +3.0*).
3 A / B	Two complete settings to compare. Both are saved with the project.
4 Bypass	The same switch as your DAW's bypass, with a short click-free fade.
5 Group	Related controls, named after what they do.
6 Control	Knob, stepped knob (choices) or switch. Effects with more than 15 controls have numbered pages at the bottom.
7 Value	In the effect's own units where it has them (dB, Hz ...).

Mouse

Drag up / down	Turn a knob
Shift + drag	Fine adjustment (10× finer)
Mouse wheel	Small steps (Shift: finer)
Double-click a knob	Back to the default value
Double-click a value	Type an exact value, Enter to confirm
Click a switch	Toggle it

Every control can be automated. Your DAW shows the effect's own parameter names.

Effect browser



Favourites	Right-click an effect or click its star to add or remove it.
Recently used	Your last 10 effects.
New	Airwindows releases from the 3 months before this Daylight_aw version.
Last added	Effects added in the latest Daylight_aw update. Empty in version 1.0.
All effects	Every effect, A to Z, followed by the Airwindows categories.
Search	Looks in effect names and descriptions.

Hover an effect to read what it does. Favourites and recently used are shared by all instances.

Presets and settings

Save preset	Type a name and press Enter. Click a preset to load it into the current A or B. Right-click to rename, move to trash or show it in its folder. Presets belong to one effect and don't include trims or bypass.
Zoom	100, 125, 150 or 200 %, for all instances.
Trims	Input trim (before the effect) and output trim (after it), ±12 dB, for gain staging. At 0 dB they are switched off completely. Keep the output trim at 0 dB on dither effects.
Tooltips	Hints and the original Airwindows parameter names when hovering. Off by default.
Reset to defaults	All controls of the effect back to their defaults.
Effect info	The full Airwindopedia text by Chris Johnson about the effect.

Your files

Presets and settings are stored in `Documents/big_tyme_designs/Daylight_aw/`. Back up this folder to keep them when you move to a new computer.

Presets	`Presets/<Effect>/<name>.dlpreset`
Settings	`settings.json` (zoom, favourites, recently used)

Troubleshooting

Plugin doesn't show up	Check the plugin folder (Installation) and rescan. On a Mac, run the `xattr` lines from INSTALL.txt.
"Access denied" when updating (Windows)	The DAW still has the plugin loaded. Close it completely, then try again.
"This effect needs a newer Daylight_aw"	The project was saved with a newer version. Update Daylight_aw. Until then, audio passes through untouched and the settings are kept.
Reverb tail cut off	Reverbs report their tail to the DAW. If a render still cuts it, add tail time in the render settings.
Bugs and ideas	Open an Issue at github.com/bigtymedesigns/daylight_aw.

Legal and credits

- **Daylight_aw**: free software under the GNU Affero General Public License v3, without any warranty. Source code: github.com/bigtymedesigns/daylight_aw.
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